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Q3 2025

PitchBook Analyst Note: Novel Ingredients

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From metabolic health to sustainable fats: Where novel ingredients are poised for the biggest exits

The novel ingredients sector is experiencing a dramatic reset. After VC funding peaked at \$5.3 billion in 2021, it dropped to \$1.5 billion in 2024—but investor interest persists, especially in early-stage deals and high-growth segments like precision fermentation, novel fats & oils, and functional health-impact ingredients. This analyst note breaks down where innovation and capital are converging in the race to meet growing demand for healthier, more sustainable, and science-backed food ingredients.

Meanwhile, mature subsegments like first-gen plant-based proteins, processed plant-based meats, and alt proteins are facing headwinds as consumers lean toward “cleaner” and more functional ingredients.

The report will analyze the latest valuation trends, spotlight emerging startups, examine regional market shifts, and identify where the next big exits will likely come from in this growing market. If you are tracking the future of food tech—from metabolic health to molecular gastronomy—you will not want to miss this one.

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